



☀ Beat the Heat

HEAT ILLNESS

When the body can't cool itself, trouble builds fast. Knowing the two stages can save a life.

HEAT EXHAUSTION

- Heavy sweating, cold/clammy skin
- Dizziness, headache, nausea
- Weak, fast pulse · muscle cramps

DO THIS

Move to cool/shade, sip water, loosen clothing, apply cool wet cloths. Rest until it passes.

HEAT STROKE

- Temp 103°F+ · hot, red skin
- Confusion or fainting
- Strong, racing pulse

⚠ CALL 911 NOW

A true emergency. Cool aggressively; don't give fluids if they're not fully alert.

💧 Summer Allergies

Grass pollen, mold, and smog peak in the warm months — sneezing, itchy eyes, and congestion follow.

CALM THE SYMPTOMS

- Check pollen counts; stay in on high days
- Shower & change after time outdoors
- Windows closed, A/C on at peak
- Antihistamines — ask us what fits you

🐝 Bee & Wasp Stings

Scrape the stinger out sideways (don't pinch — that squeezes in more venom). Wash, then cold compress.

EASE IT

- Ice 10 min on/off for swelling
- Antihistamine for itch, ibuprofen for pain

⚠ CALL 911 IF

Lips/tongue/throat swell, hives spread, or breathing gets hard — use an EpiPen if prescribed.

🌸 Heat Rash & Prickly Skin

SKIN

Trapped sweat plugs the skin's ducts, leaving tiny red, prickly bumps — usually in folds, on the neck, chest, or where clothing rubs. Common in babies and on muggy days.

SOOTHE & PREVENT

Cool down and keep skin **dry**. Choose loose, breathable cotton, skip heavy creams/ointments, and use a fan or A/C. It usually clears on its own in a few days — see us if it blisters, weeps, or won't fade.

☀ Summer Factoids

#1

Heat is the deadliest weather hazard in the U.S. — more deaths most years than floods, tornadoes & hurricanes

10×

A car can heat up ~20°F in **10 minutes**. Never leave kids or pets — not even “just a sec.”

1.5L

You can sweat out **over a liter an hour** in heat. Thirst lags behind — drink **before** you feel it.

15 min

Unprotected skin can **burn in 15 minutes**. UV peaks 10am–4pm — reapply SPF every 2 hrs



Pee check: pale-yellow = hydrated. Dark = drink up. Simplest hydration gauge there is

Summer-Ready Care

One membership, your doctor a text away — perfect for the season's scrapes, stings & sniffles.

Direct Primary Care **\$99/mo**

Unlimited visits

Weight Management

MD-supervised

CoreLift Pelvic Health

FDA-cleared

GLP-1

New!



Smart & Safe Summer Activities

Make the most of the season — a few easy habits keep the fun going.

- ✓ **Hydrate early & often**
Carry water; add fruit or a pinch of electrolytes on sweaty days.
- ✓ **SPF 30+, reapply**
Every 2 hours and after swimming or sweating. Hat & shades help too.
- ✓ **Bug-smart**
Repellent for mosquitoes & ticks; check for ticks after trails & tall grass.
- ✓ **Know your meds**
Some prescriptions raise sun & heat sensitivity — ask Dr. Tess if yours do.
- ✓ **Time it right**
Save hard exercise & yard work for early morning or evening, out of peak sun.
- ✓ **Water safety**
Never swim alone; watch kids closely; learn the signs of quiet drowning.
- ✓ **Cookout care**
Keep cold food cold; don't let plates sit out over 2 hrs (1 hr if 90°F+).
- ✓ **Hot pavement check**
If it's too hot for your hand for 5 sec, it's too hot for bare feet & paws.

DID YOU KNOW?

🐝 **Bees die after one sting; wasps don't.** Wasps & hornets can sting again and again — back away calmly, don't swat.

💧 **Humidity makes heat worse.** Sweat can't evaporate in muggy air, so your body's main cooling system stalls.

🐾 **Hooch's tip:** dogs cool by panting, not sweating. Shade, water, and cool ground keep our Comfort Specialist happy.

🍉 **Eat your water.** Watermelon, cucumber & berries are ~90% water — tasty hydration that beats the heat.

WHEN TO REACH OUT

With **Direct Primary Care**, you don't have to wonder whether something's "worth a visit." **Just text Dr. Tess.** A weird rash, a bad sting, allergies that won't quit, or a fever that won't break — get a real answer from a doctor who knows you, often the same day.

SAME-DAY CARE

Stings, rashes, heat illness, summer bugs

ALLERGY RELIEF

A plan tailored to your triggers

WHOLE FAMILY

Kids to grandparents, one doctor

A note from GFM: This newsletter shares general wellness information for the summer season and is **not a substitute for personal medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.** For anything concerning — and especially for signs of heat stroke or a severe allergic reaction — **call 911 or seek care right away.** Questions about your own health? That's exactly what your membership is for — reach out to Dr. Tess any time.